

5 Fitness Lies Keeping You Fat

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 09, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LcnA4SIYmug> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter dismantles five pervasive fitness myths — from "sustainable" slow fat loss to skipping calorie tracking — and lays out a simple, aggressive, math-based system to get lean fast, then coast at maintenance.

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Lie 1: Fat Loss Should Be Slow and Sustainable 0:00

- The common advice is to pick a "sustainable" long-term approach — Brandon calls this "stupid"
 - His reasoning: if fat loss is taking a long time, it means the approach isn't working
 - The goal is to get ripped *fast*, reach your ideal body weight, and *then* maintain long term
- **Rocket ship analogy:** a rocket burns massive fuel to escape the atmosphere, then drops the fuel tanks and coasts
 - You don't design a "long-term launch strategy" — you blast out of the atmosphere and then cruise
 - Your body is the same: go hard to get lean, then shift to a sustainable maintenance phase
- Why trainers push "sustainable" advice — two possible reasons:
 - They're too soft to do anything hardcore themselves
 - They think you're too weak to handle an aggressive approach
 - Brandon acknowledges both might sometimes be true
- **The get-ripped formula** (cutting phase):
 - Take your bodyweight in pounds $\times 10$ = daily calorie target
 - Get 1 gram of protein per pound of bodyweight daily to preserve muscle
 - In your first year of training (natural athletes only), you can build muscle *and* lose fat simultaneously while in a caloric deficit

- 70% of calories burned each day come from basic bodily functions (pumping blood, breathing, etc.) — so the deficit works even without exercise
- Add 20,000 steps per day to accelerate fat loss further
 - Brandon himself hit 20,000 steps every day the week before filming this video
 - A commenter called 20k steps "not sustainable" — his point: you only need it for the aggressive cutting phase, not forever
- **Maintenance formula** (after reaching goal):
 - Drop to ~10,000 steps per day
 - Calories: bodyweight × 12–15
 - Protein: still 1 gram per pound of bodyweight — never stop this



Lie 2: You Need Intense Cardio to Burn Fat 3:08

- The truth: fat loss is purely about burning more calories than you consume — your body does not care *how* you burn them
 - Sprints, incline walking, elliptical, jumping rope — all equal if the calorie burn is the same
 - The type of cardio is irrelevant to fat loss
- Brandon personally prefers **low-intensity cardio** for two reasons:
 - Age — high-impact cardio like sprints is hard on joints in your 40s
 - Convenience — he does most of it passively while working
- His setup:
 - Multiple exercise bikes at home, two connected to standing desks ("desk bikes") — pedals while working
 - Does Instagram/TikTok live streams while on an exercise bike on his balcony — that's his closest thing to dedicated cardio
 - Pedals at a pace low enough to hold a full conversation
- His aggressive cutting target: **~3,500 total calories burned per day** (not just active calories — total daily expenditure)
- Bottom line: do whatever cardio you actually enjoy or can stick to — sprints, battle ropes, walking, cycling — it genuinely doesn't matter
- **Tool recommendation:** use a fitness tracker to measure daily calorie burn
 - None are 100% accurate, but they give a useful barometer
 - Devices mentioned: Oura Ring (his choice), Apple Watch, Garmin, Whoop, Fitbit



Lie 3: You Can't Out-Train a Bad Diet 5:23

- The saying "you can't out-train a bad diet" is actually **true** — but there's a flip side

You can't out-train a bad diet — but you CAN out-diet bad training.

- Diet is more powerful than training; you don't even need to exercise to lose significant fat
- **Client case study:** a severely obese man who was too overweight to do a single push-up
 - Phase 1: diet only — no gym, no steps, no exercise whatsoever
 - Brought his calories down to a normal human level (not even extreme restriction)
 - Result: **lost 75 pounds in 70 days** barely leaving his house
 - Phase 2: added walking and step tracking once he'd lost the initial weight
 - Phase 3: introduced gym training only after he was physically capable
 - Key reasoning: putting a severely obese person on sprints or heavy exercise would have destroyed his joints
- Real-world proof that training without diet control fails:
 - Brandon worked in some of the best gyms in America
 - Saw aerobics instructors — whose entire job was high-intensity cardio all day — who were still fat
 - Conclusion: they could have been lean without any exercise if they'd just fixed their diet
- Hierarchy: **diet > everything else** in the fat loss equation

Lie 4: You Don't Need Supplements 6:59

- Technically true — you don't *need* supplements, but you don't *need* anything beyond food, water, and shelter
 - Everything beyond survival basics is optimization
 - Saying "you don't need supplements" is the same logic as saying you don't need a car, a phone, or a comfortable home
- Supplements aren't necessary — they're **convenient and effective optimizations**
- **Protein shakes:**
 - At ~200 lbs and 2,000 calories/day, hitting 200g of protein from whole food alone means enormous amounts of meat every meal
 - Protein shakes offer an ideal protein-to-calorie ratio — high protein, low extra calories
 - Convenience example: instead of buying, cooking, eating, and washing dishes for a steak, he grabs a pre-made shake, shakes it, drinks it in 30 seconds, and gets 40g of protein
- **Creatine:**
 - One of the most studied supplements ever; safety and efficacy are "above reproach"
 - Proven to significantly help build muscle
 - Newer studies show it also improves brain function and mood
 - Getting sufficient creatine from red meat alone requires eating a very large amount daily — supplementing is cheaper and easier
- **Pre-workout:**
 - Useful on low-motivation days when you don't feel like training

- His experience: beta-alanine causes ear tingling, 300mg of caffeine causes eye twitching and a rush — makes it hard *not* to work out
- **The "holy trinity" of supplements** he recommends:
 - Protein shakes
 - Creatine
 - Pre-workout
- Note: he's not even discussing peptides or advanced compounds — just these three basics

Lie 5: You Don't Need to Track Calories 10:06

- Some influencers brag about not tracking calories — Brandon's take:
 - Most of them are in their early 20s; he dares them to try that approach in their 40s and stay lean
 - More importantly: not tracking means you're asking "what's the least I can do?" rather than "how do I win?"
- **Finance analogy:** running your diet without tracking calories is like running a business with no accounting department — you'll go broke
 - "You think you're just going to accidentally be doing this right?"
- **The math of fat loss:**

Goal	Required Deficit
Lose 1 lb of fat	Burn 3,500 more calories than consumed
Lose 1 lb/week	500 calorie/day deficit
Lose 2 lbs/week	1,000 calorie/day deficit

- Brandon's personal target during cuts: **1,000 calorie deficit daily** → 2 lbs of fat lost per week
- **Obesity stat used to drive urgency:**
 - 1,500 Americans die every day from obesity-related diseases
 - For context: only ~3,000 people died on 9/11 — obesity kills the equivalent of a 9/11 every *other day*
 - "100% of people who die of obesity-related diseases — none of them tracked their calories"
- Everyone he knows who tracks calories consistently looks incredible — often accused of being on steroids
 - Doing what most people don't do gets you results most people don't have
- **How to track — his AI-powered system:**
 - Tool: **Claude** (AI) synced with **Apple Health**
 - He DMs the prompt to anyone who messages him "tracking" on Instagram (@KingKeto)
 - Workflow:
 - Tell Claude what you ate (text description or photo of the nutrition label)
 - Claude gives a running total of calories, protein, and other macros for the day

- Claude syncs with Apple Health to pull total calories burned
- Claude calculates your current deficit in real time
- Can ask conversational questions: e.g., "How much steak do I need to hit my protein goal?" — answer: "about 4.5 oz"
- Can photograph a plate of food at a restaurant when you don't have a scale — Claude estimates the macros
- Even tracked the hibachi sauce on his plate — catching hidden calories most people miss
- Say "new day" to reset the conversation
- Requires a wearable device to sync calorie burn data (Oura, Apple Watch, etc.)
- Brandon notes tracking was genuinely hard in the 1990s (he used paper notebooks); MyFitnessPal made it easier; AI makes it easier than ever

🎯 Coaching Offer & Wrap-Up 15:53

- Brandon is in his 40s — emphasizes it's never too late to get in great shape
- Offers **one-on-one fitness coaching** (application link in video description)
 - Services include: custom diet plan, macro targets, workout programming, daily accountability check-ins
 - He personally reviews each client's nutrition and workout data every day and reaches out to them directly
- **Free resource:** DM "tracking" to his Instagram (@KingKeto) to receive his Claude AI calorie-tracking prompt